

Innovation Features Implemented

Student Number: G00425757

Overview

Alongside the core assignment requirements, I chose to implement a number of additional features aimed at improving the overall usability and user experience of the application.

The goal here was not simply to meet the minimum brief, but to make the app feel more polished, intuitive, and practical from a user perspective.

1. Loading Indicators

Loading spinners were implemented when retrieving data from The Movie Database (TMDB) API.

This was added to give users clear visual feedback while data is being fetched, rather than leaving the interface appearing idle or unresponsive.

Implemented for:

- Loading trending movies
- Movie search operations

Although API responses are often quite fast, the functionality is in place to improve responsiveness and user feedback. In practice, the loading spinner does not appear if page loading times are particularly short.

2. Toast Notifications

Toast notifications were added when users interact with favourites.

Examples include:

- “Added to favourites”

- “Removed from favourites”

This provides immediate confirmation that an action has been completed successfully, making the app feel more responsive and user-friendly.

3. Favourite Counter

A live favourite counter was added to the favourites icon on the Home page.



This allows users to immediately see how many saved favourites they currently have without needing to navigate away from the main page.

It is a small feature, but one that improves convenience and usability.

4. Direct Favourite Removal

While the assignment required favourites to be stored and displayed, I also added the ability to remove favourites directly from the Favourites page.

Without this, users would need to open each movie individually before removing it.

This makes favourites management quicker, simpler, and more practical.

5. No Search Results Feedback

An empty-state message was added for situations where a movie search returns no results.

Example:

“No movies found matching your search.”

This improves clarity for the user and avoids situations where an empty page could appear confusing or appear to be an application issue.

6. Movie Sorting Functionality

A sorting feature was implemented to allow users to organise movie results in different ways.

Available options:

- Title (A–Z)
- Popularity
- Release Date

This adds meaningful functionality beyond the original specification and gives users more control over how they browse content.

7. Improved Navigation

Additional navigation controls were implemented throughout the application to make movement between screens faster and more intuitive.

These include:

- Home navigation shortcuts
- Favourites navigation shortcuts
- quicker movement between related pages

This helps the app feel more complete and easier to use as a real application rather than simply a technical prototype.

Summary

Overall, these additions were implemented to improve usability, responsiveness, and general user experience beyond the minimum project requirements.

The focus was on practical enhancements that make the application more intuitive to use, while also demonstrating additional use of Ionic functionality and independent development work beyond the base specification.